2. Express News Service, ‘Janata Party bans dual membership’, *The Indian Express*, 30 July 1979, p. 1.
3. The RSS ‘dual membership’ of erstwhile Jan Sangh members in Janata Party became a lightning rod for infighting and factionism at least from 1978 onwards. The Charan Singh/Raj Narain faction, supported by ex-socialist leader Madhu Limaye, sought to attack Prime Minister Morarji Desai by attacking his ex-Jan Sangh allies, Atal Bihari Vajpayee and L.K. Advani. The resulting crisis led to the expulsion of Raj Narain from Janata Party on 12 June 1979. He formed the Janata Party (Secular) with a group of forty-seven breakaway MPs, which led to the collapse of the Morarji Desai government. Charan Singh became prime minister on 28 July 1979, leading a minority government, supported by Janata (S), Yashwantrao Chavan of Congress (Socialist) and outside support of Indira Gandhi’s Congress (I). Singh had to resign on 20 August 1979 when Congress (I) withdrew support. Details here from Christophe Jaffrelot, *The Hindu Nationalist Movement and Indian Politics: 1925 to the 1990s* (New Delhi: Penguin, 1999), pp. 307–312.
4. PTI, ‘RSS issue—it’s a fight to finish: Ram’, *The Times of India*, 29 February 1980, p. 1.
5. Special Correspondent, ‘Jan Sangh group to form new party’, *The Times of India*, 5 April 1980, p. 1.
6. The ECI on 24 April 1980 initially gave the BJP recognition as a national party on the basis of its claim that it represented the majority of the undivided Janata Party. The BJP said it would not claim the flag or the symbol of the Janata Party. The ECI also accepted the BJP’s pitch for the ‘lotus’ as a party symbol after an earlier proposal for allotment of a ‘wheel (with five spokes) and the elephant’ was not accepted by the ECI. However, the ECI’s initial decision left the residuary Janata Party with the problem of recognition as a national party, after its symbol, the ‘haldhar within wheel’, was frozen by the Commission. Once an election symbol is frozen, it amounted to automatic withdrawal of recognition to a political party. This meant that the Chandra Shekhar-led Janata Party would have had to fight the upcoming election that year under a new name, unless its symbol was unfrozen. Chandra